Fall Back! Daylight Saving Time Ends on November 1

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On November 1, 2026, many people in North America will turn their clocks back one hour. This ends **Daylight Saving Time**, or DST, which began on March 8, 2026. The change gives more sunlight in the morning during the shorter winter days.

DST started during World War I. In 1916, the German Empire moved clocks forward to save fuel, and the US and Britain soon did the same. It came back in World War II. After 1945, different US places used different dates. By 1965, Iowa alone had 23 sets of dates! The **Uniform Time Act** of 1966 set the same dates for the country, but Hawaii, most of Arizona and some US **territories** do not take part.

About 70 countries use DST, but experts say changing clocks can disturb sleep. The House passed the **Sunshine Protection Act** by 308-117 in July 2026 to make DST **permanent**, but the Senate has not approved it yet. For now, enjoy the extra hour!

Word Treasure

Daylight Saving Time -- The practice of moving clocks forward in spring and back in autumn to change when daylight falls.

Uniform Time Act -- A US law from 1966 that set the same clock-change dates for the whole country.

territories -- Areas that belong to a country but are not states, such as islands governed by the US.

permanent -- Lasting forever, or at least with no planned end.

Sunshine Protection Act -- A proposed US law that would keep Daylight Saving Time all year round.

Background you need

Daylight Saving Time moves clocks forward in spring so the evening stays light longer, then back again in autumn.

Countries first used the idea during wartime to save fuel by needing less artificial light.

Today governments still debate whether changing the clocks twice a year is helpful or harmful.

Break it down

WHO: People in North America and about 70 countries that use Daylight Saving Time
WHAT: Clocks turn back one hour as Daylight Saving Time ends for the year
WHERE: Across the United States, except Hawaii, most of Arizona and some US territories
WHY: DST was created to save fuel in wartime by shifting daylight, and shared national dates were set by the Uniform Time Act of 1966

Why it matters

The clock change affects everyone's sleep and daily schedule, so knowing the date helps families get ready for the shorter winter days.

Test what you remember

1. On what date does Daylight Saving Time end in 2026?

- (A) December 25, 2026
- (B) March 8, 2026
- (C) November 1, 2026
- (D) July 4, 2026

2. How do the clocks change when DST ends?

- (A) Back one hour
- (B) Forward one hour
- (C) They do not change
- (D) Forward two hours

3. Why did the German Empire first move clocks forward in 1916?

- (A) To help farmers
- (B) To save fuel
- (C) To match other countries
- (D) For a sports event

4. Which US places do not take part in DST?

- (A) New York and California
- (B) Alaska only
- (C) Texas and Florida
- (D) Hawaii, most of Arizona and some US territories

5. What do experts say changing the clocks can do?

- (A) Make people taller
- (B) Disturb sleep
- (C) Improve everyone's sleep
- (D) Change the weather

6. What did the House of Representatives pass in July 2026?

- (A) The Sunshine Protection Act, to make DST permanent
- (B) A rule to change clocks four times a year
- (C) A ban on clocks in schools
- (D) A law ending all time zones

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: B 4: D 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Experts on sleep: Say changing the clocks can disturb people's sleep.**

2. **The House of Representatives: Passed the Sunshine Protection Act to make DST permanent, but the Senate has not approved it yet.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):